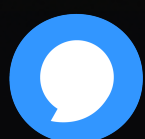


HALF A MILLION IN BLACK FRIDAY SALES. THEN WE OPENED THE JANUARY REVIEW.

How we plan Black Friday for profit now.



LEIGHTON PENROSE

Co-Owner, Leading Social

SWIPE →

A few years ago one of our clients had a huge Black Friday.

ABOUT HALF A MILLION IN SALES IN JUST A FEW DAYS.

They celebrated, and to be honest we thought it was great too.

Then January came.

WHEN WE REVIEWED IT IN JANUARY, **THE MARGINS WERE GONE.**

25%

SITEWIDE DISCOUNT

They had run a sitewide 25% discount with:

no contribution margin tracked

no CAC target set

and spend scaled fast with nothing protecting the profit

Half a million in sales, and the money just wasn't really being made.

THAT ONE WAS ON US AS WELL.

I think it was 2021. Back then we made the creative and ran the ads. We had no sight of the client's figures, and we never asked for them.

Since then we've put the financial side in place, so that doesn't happen again.

The first change was the numbers. Before anyone touches creative or campaigns, **five of them go on paper:**

- | | | |
|----|-------------------------|---|
| 01 | REVENUE GOAL | What's the Black Friday revenue goal? |
| 02 | CUSTOMERS NEEDED | How many customers do you need to hit it? |
| 03 | TARGET CAC | What's your target CAC? |
| 04 | BREAK-EVEN | Where's your break-even point? |
| 05 | MER FLOOR | What's your MER floor? |

We also get much more involved in the offer and the product COGS, to make sure everything is profitable.

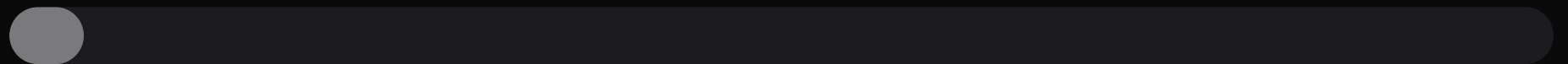
THE SECOND CHANGE WAS **THE CALENDAR.**

A lot of brands treat Black Friday like a four-day sprint, or a crazy four weeks in November.

With our clients we run it as a 12-week campaign.

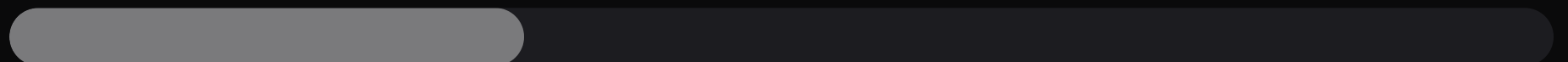
4 DAYS

the sprint



4 WEEKS

the November rush



12 WEEKS

how we run it



The 12 weeks usually break down like this.

THE 12-WEEK TIMELINE WE RUN WITH CLIENTS

SUMMER AND SEPTEMBER

LEAD GEN AND LIST BUILDING

LATE SEPTEMBER. YOU ARE PROBABLY HERE.

OCTOBER

**AUDIENCE WARMING, OFFER TESTING,
CREATIVE TESTING**

EARLY NOVEMBER

**VIP EARLY ACCESS AND EXCLUSIVE
BUNDLES**

BLACK FRIDAY WEEK

THE MAIN CAMPAIGN

DECEMBER

SELF-PURCHASE MESSAGING

If you're reading this in late September, the list-building window is probably closing.

OCTOBER IS STILL FULLY AHEAD OF YOU,

with audience warming, offer testing and creative testing to do.

So the offer and the creative usually get tested well before the main campaign starts.

Then Black Friday week arrives, and we track it like any other sales period:

01 **NET SALES**

02 **MER**

03 **NEW CUSTOMERS AGAINST RETURNING CUSTOMERS**

04 **AND NEW CUSTOMER ACQUISITION COST**

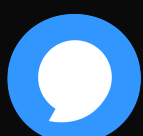
We'll throw an eye over ROAS on the platforms, and that's about it. To be honest it rarely tells the true story.

For the spend, I pull a brand's last five years of data and work from the averages.

I've put the five numbers and the 12-week timeline into one planner.

COMMENT **BFCM
AND I'LL SEND THE
PLANNER.**

Follow Leighton Penrose for more on planning growth around profit.



LEIGHTON PENROSE

Co-Owner, Leading Social